

Zero to Launch: The Lean Service Business Blueprint

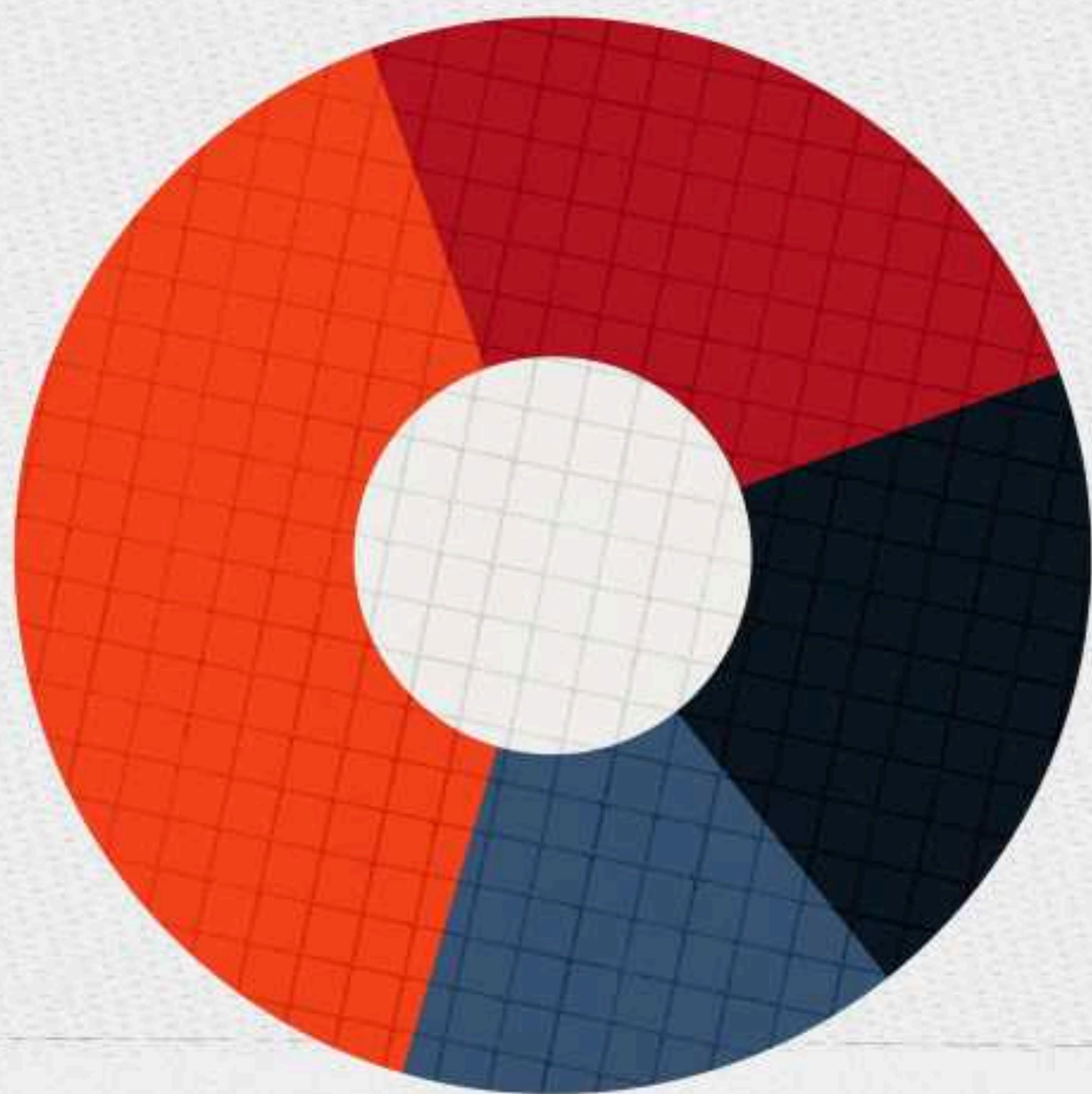
You don't need funding, a fancy brand, or even a website to start a service business. **Just a clear offer and the right people to say yes.**

SMART MONEY ALLOCATION

Where your limited funds should go:

40%
Basic marketing
(branding, outbound tools, lead gen)

Tip: You don't need to automate right away. Focus on delivering results manually first.



25%
Tooling
(invoicing, scheduling, docs)

20%
Legal/admin setup

15%
Contingency buffer

ESSENTIAL TOOLS

Save ~\$600+ annually by ditching complex tools for leaner ones:

FUNCTION	PREMIUM TOOL	FREE/LOW-COST ALTERNATIVE
Website	Wix Premium (\$16/mo)	Carrd (\$9/yr) or Notion (Free)
Scheduling	Calendly Pro (\$12/mo)	Calendly (Free)
Contracts + Invoicing	HoneyBook (\$39/mo)	Bonsai (Starter), Wave (Free)
Design	Adobe Suite (\$60/mo)	Canva (Free) + Templates
Email Outreach	Instantly.ai (\$30/mo)	Mailtrack + Gmail + Clay (Free stack)
Admin Templates	Custom Legal + SOPs (\$300+)	Open-source legal templates, ChatGPT, Notion

QUICK-WIN TACTICS

- **Simple portfolio:** Use Notion to showcase 3 results and a contact form
- **LinkedIn outreach:** Send 10 personalized DMs per day for 2 weeks
- **Launch offer:** First 3 clients get 25% off or free strategy call
- **One call close:** Pre-write proposal templates so you can close on the call

ACTION STEPS

- ☐ Write out your offer using this formula: "I help [X] do [Y] without [Z]"
- ☐ Build a landing page with Calendly embedded
- ☐ Reach out to 10 people in your personal network
- ☐ Create a service checklist or welcome doc in Notion
- ☐ Post your offer on LinkedIn or in a niche Slack group

THE 3-STEP LAUNCH

STEP 1: VALIDATE (\$0)

- Clarify your offer: Who you help + the result you deliver
- Write 2-3 outcome-focused value props
- Reach out to 10 people in your network for feedback or pilot clients

STEP 2: BUILD (≤\$300)

- Create a 1-page landing page on Carrd or Notion
- Set up Calendly for bookings + Wave for invoicing
- Use open-source legal templates for contracts
- Build a lightweight CRM in Notion or Sheets

STEP 3: LAUNCH (\$100–\$300)

- DM warm leads and previous clients with your offer
- Create a "starter package" with clear scope + price
- Post a client result or testimonial on LinkedIn
- Ask for 3 referrals from happy clients